

REHAN ALI MIRZA

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3620 Walnut St, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania - 19104, United States

EDUCATION

- University of Pennsylvania**
Ph.D. in Communications
Aug 2025 - Present
Philadelphia, PA, U.S.
• **Advisor:** Sandra González-Bailón | Affiliation: Center for Information Networks and Democracy (CIND)
• **Research:** Prosocial platform design, user behavior, platform governance, AI-mediated communication
- Harvard Kennedy School**
Master in Public Policy
May 2023
Cambridge, MA, U.S.
Capstone thesis: Tracking digital censorship of prosocial platform use cases in autocratic contexts
- University College London**
MSc. Global Health and Development
September 2016
London, U.K.
Distinction, top 5 in cohort of 90+ students
- University of Cambridge**
B.A. Economics
June 2014
Cambridge, U.K.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- University of Pennsylvania**
Doctoral Researcher
Aug 2025 - Present
Philadelphia, PA
• Fielded experiment proving evidence of moderator viewpoint alignment effects on content moderation
• Developed multi-dimensional metric for measuring online discourse quality across 8 dimensions; designed study to validate metric using design-based supervised learning approach
- Prosocial Design Network**
Fellow
Apr 2025 - Present
Remote
• Co-facilitated expert working group on researcher-practitioner collaboration; co-authored [published report](#) on catalyzing actionable research for healthy digital spaces
• Led social media section of [published report](#) mapping LLM-based tools fostering public discourse
• Analyzed 30+ tools and surveyed 25+ tool developers and stakeholders to inform mapping framework
- Department of Government, University of Birmingham**
Research Associate
Oct 2024 - Jul 2025
Birmingham, U.K.
• Statistical and geospatial analysis, and conceptual framework development to support climate and health engagement research
- Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School**
Policy Researcher
2023-24
Cambridge, MA
• Analyzed platform governance using Facebook Papers dataset for policy recommendations
• Developed voter education resources on responsible social media use
• Engaged with FCC, FTC, and Obama Foundation on digital governance initiatives

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Strategy Consultant | L.E.K. Consulting**
London, U.K. | 2017-21
• Quantitative modeling and data analysis across 20+ projects for public sector and commercial clients
• 60+ semi-structured stakeholder interviews; survey design and large dataset analysis
- Research Intern | UNICEF Innovation**
Copenhagen, Denmark | 2015
Market research and data analysis on emerging health technology products
- Intern | World Health Organization**
Geneva, Switzerland | 2014-15
Organized Global mHypertension Workshop engaging 60+ cross-sector experts

SELECTED PROJECTS

- Pensieve:** Automated Research Management System *Fall 2024 - Present*
- Developing LLM-powered tool for academic literature management and synthesis
- Integrity Institute:** Tech Policy Tracker - Operational Lead *Aug 2024 - Present*
- Voluntary project - built database for tracking U.S. federal and state technology legislation, including a front-end searchable repository
 - Developed semi-automated pipeline using ML for bill summarization and vector search
- Trustible (AI Governance Platform):** Consultant *Jul 2023 - Oct 2023*
- Interviewed privacy professionals on organizational AI governance readiness
- Twitter/X Capstone Project:** Researcher *Oct 2022 - Apr 2023*
- Mixed-methods analysis of Twitter's prosocial use cases in autocratic contexts

PUBLICATIONS

Policy Publications:

- Giardini, T., Buza, M., & Mirza, R. (2025). **Global Digital Policy Roundup: May 2025**. *Tech Policy Press*.
- Mirza, R., Giardini, T., & Buza, M. (2025). **How Can Governments Regulate Default Settings to Unlock User-Friendly Features?**. *Tech Policy Press*.
- Mirza, R. (2024). **How AI deepfakes threaten the 2024 elections**. *The Journalists Resource*.
- Mirza, R. (2023). **Privacy Pioneers: AI as the New Frontier**. *Trustible*.
- Skeadas, T., Mirza, R., & Vishwanath, M. (2023). **Digital Disruption: Measuring the Social and Economic Costs of Internet Shutdowns**. *Tech Policy Press*.

Research Reports:

- Prosocial Design Network (2026). **Connecting Researchers & Practitioners to Catalyze Actionable Research**. *Contributing author*.
- Prosocial Design Network (2024). **Mapping LLM-enabled Tools for Public Discourse, Pluralism, and Social Cohesion**. *Contributing author - led social media section*.

Discussion Papers & Case Studies:

- Mirza, R. (2023). **Case Study on Online Youth Harms – Project Daisy**. *Shorenstein Center*.
- Mirza, R. (2023). **Integrity or Influence? Facebook's Governance Trade-offs in India**. *Shorenstein Center*.
- Jetty, S., Chen, T., & Mirza, R. (2022). **Meme War: The GameStop Short Squeeze Campaign**. *Media Manipulation Casebook*.

PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

- "Motivated moderation: How partisan alignment influences civility judgments in community-based meme forums"**
- Mirza, R., "Guardrails in Communication Networks", CIND, May 1, 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Research Methods:** Experimental methods, statistical analysis, geospatial analysis, survey design, content analysis, literature reviews, semi-structured interviews
- **Programming:** Python, R, Stata, API integration, ML/NLP deployment
- **Tools & Platforms:** GitHub, Qualtrics, Tableau, database management, web development (basic)

TEACHING & SERVICE

- **Course Assistantships:** Politics of the Press (Prof. Nancy Gibbs, Harvard Kennedy School, Fall 2022); Politics and Ethics in Unstable Times (Prof. Yanilda Gonzalez, Harvard Kennedy School, Spring 2023)
- **Academic Advising:** Dudley Community, Harvard College (2022-2023)
- **Professional Service:** Co-founder, Writers Professional Interest Group, Harvard Kennedy School (2022-2023)